FRANKFURT, GERMANY

Städel Museum: Masterpieces

Twenty paintings that shift attention between a meal, a face, a small object and a public interior.



Monet's *Luncheon* gives a family meal a canvas more than two metres high. Juncker's isolated fruit achieves another kind of enlargement: insects and a stone support make an apple or pear seem unusually consequential within a small arrangement. In both cases, an ordinary subject acquires attention through the terms of its presentation.

This selection moves between those scales. A grimace can occupy a whole image; a crowd can become small within a church or exchange hall. Looking at what surrounds a subject, and how much room it is given, helps explain its effect without resorting to a ranking of masterpieces. The entries retain the collection's variety rather than promising one continuous history.

Artline selected these works from documented museum holdings. The selection is independent of the museum, and individual works may be on loan or off display. Dates and attributions retain the qualifications in the linked records.

Explore this selection in Artline

See the selected works alongside books and events from their period, or compare when the artists lived. The books and events provide context, not evidence of direct influence. Works without confirmed dates remain in this guide.

Artworks in context Who lived when?

artlines.org/guides/staedel-museum

The selection · 20

1. The Luncheon
   Claude Monet · 1868-1869
2. The Lucca Madonna
   Jan van Eyck · 1436
3. Ecce Homo
   Hieronymus Bosch · 1475-1480
4. Young Woman of the Fürleger Family with Loose Hair
   Albrecht Dürer · 1497
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20. Kitchen Interior with Three Women
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The Luncheon

Claude Monet

1868-1869 · Städel Museum



Claude Monet. The Luncheon. Städel Museum, Frankfurt am Main. Public Domain Mark (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame proportional resize and JPEG compression. · Public Domain Mark 1.0

The bright tablecloth reaches into the foreground, connecting figures who do not all share one action. At over two metres high, the painting gives a private meal the physical scale associated with more public subjects. Monet's dishes, glasses and furnished room therefore deserve more than a quick recognition as domestic accessories: they help hold the large composition together.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: SG 170

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The Lucca Madonna

Jan van Eyck

1436 · Städel Museum



Jan van Eyck. The Lucca Madonna. Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

The red robe and throne establish authority within a room whose narrow enclosure also feels materially specific. Windows and small furnishings prevent the setting from becoming an indefinite sacred space. Van Eyck brings two registers into contact. Mary can possess ceremonial importance while holding the child close within surroundings that invite attention to ordinary things.

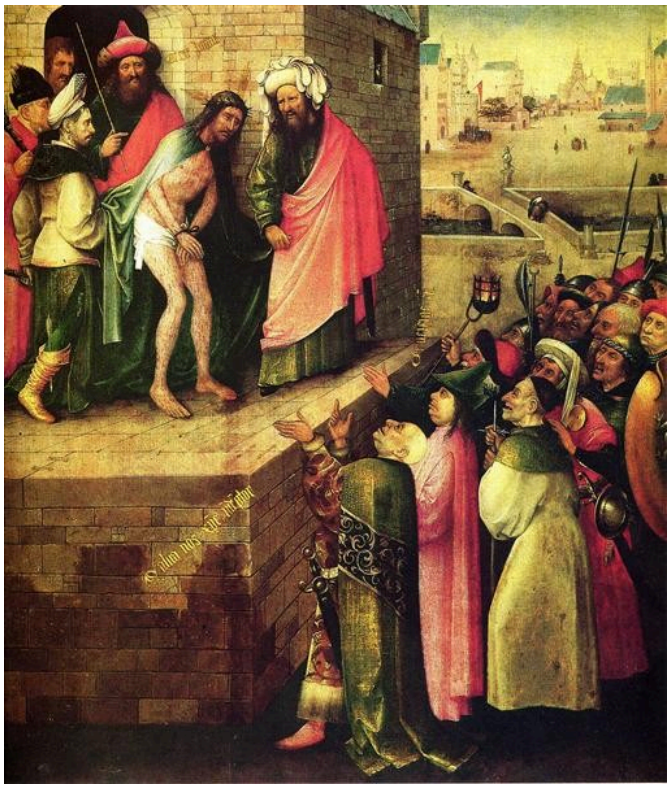
Object source · Open artwork

03 / 20

Ecce Homo

Hieronymus Bosch

1475-1480 · Städel Museum



Hieronymus Bosch. Here is a Man (Ecce Homo). Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

The raised platform exposes Christ to a compact crowd below. Architecture separates the figure being presented from the people looking upwards, making public judgment a visible arrangement. Bosch gives the crowd force through its concentration of faces and bright clothing. The scene's hostility is embodied in that unequal relation between exposure and collective attention.

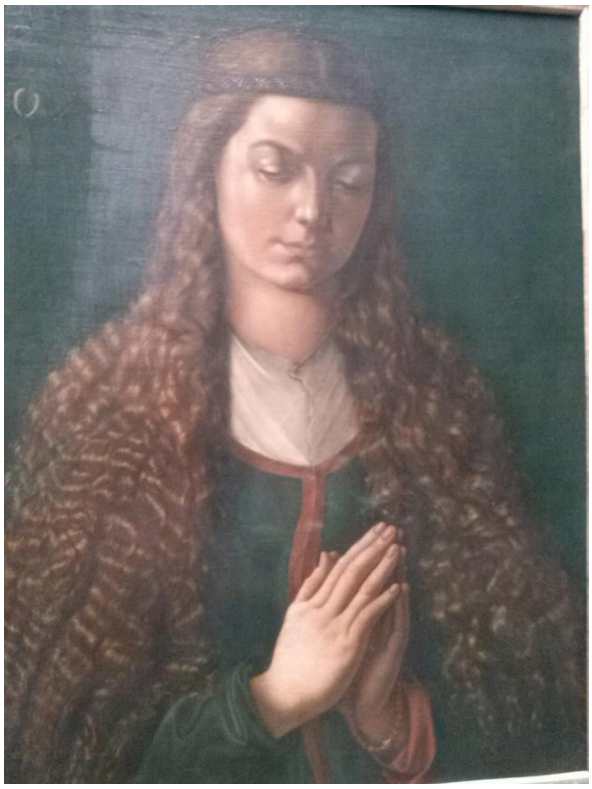
Object source · Open artwork

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Young Woman of the Fürleger Family with Loose Hair

Albrecht Dürer

1497 · Städel Museum



Albrecht Dürer. Portrait of a Young Fürleger with Loose Hair. Image credit: Albrecht Dürer; Own work; Photographic credit: Sima Farshid. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Portrait_of_a_Young_Woman,_Albrecht_D%C3%BCrer_(1497).jpg. CC BY-SA 4.0 (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/4.0/). Full-frame resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · CC BY-SA 4.0

Lowered eyes and joined hands draw the portrait towards an inward-directed gesture, while carefully described curls spread around the face. Dürer keeps the background restrained enough for those contours to remain important. The quiet pose does not make the surface uneventful. Hair, hands and face each require a different kind of precise attention.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 937

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Helene Roederstein

Ottilie Roederstein

1890 · Städel Museum



Ottilie Roederstein. Portrait of Helene Roederstein. Image credit: Ottilie Roederstein; Source credit: Städelmuseum, Frankfurt am Main. Wikimedia Commons. CC BY-SA 4.0 (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/4.0). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · CC BY-SA 4.0

The patterned green dress introduces considerable activity below a comparatively steady face. Joined hands help keep the posture clear, and the pale hat distinguishes the head from the muted background. Ottilie Roederstein allows decoration to remain conspicuous without dispersing the sitter. The portrait's balance depends on different levels of incident across one figure.

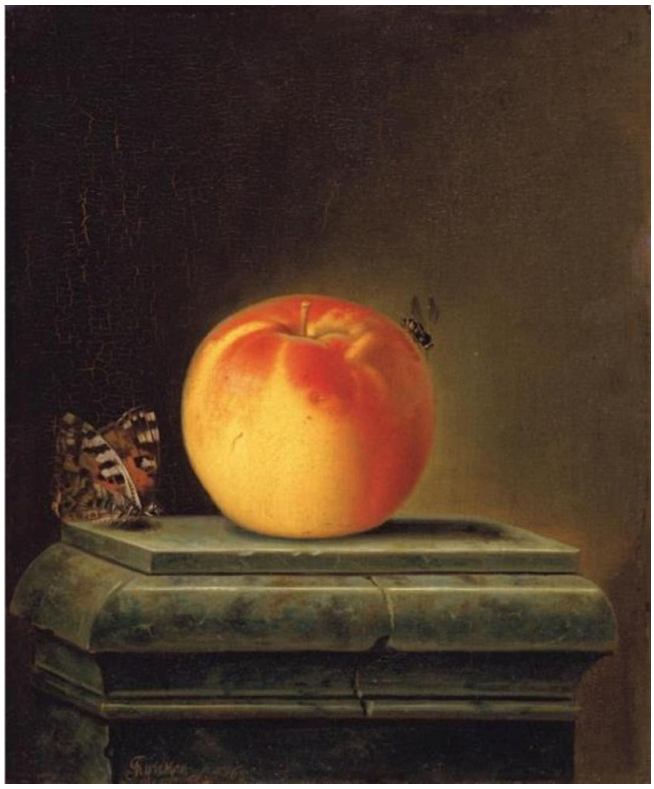
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 2037

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Still Life with Apple and Insects

Justus Juncker

1765 · Städel Museum



Justus Juncker. Still Life with Apple and Insects. Image credit: Justus Juncker; Source credit: https://rkd.nl/nl/explore/images/281212. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

A stepped stone support gives the single apple the formality of a displayed object. Tiny insects introduce another scale against which its roundness becomes substantial. Juncker removes the abundance usual in many fruit still lifes. Isolation makes a commonplace subject available for sustained attention to outline, skin and the small life around it.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 1614

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Still Life with Pear and Insects

Justus Juncker

1765 · Städel Museum



Justus Juncker. Still Life with Pear and Insects. Image credit: Justus Juncker; Source credit: https://rkd.nl/nl/explore/images/281213. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The pear rises from the stone ledge with a less balanced outline than the neighbouring apple. Butterfly and insect bring delicate forms into contact with fruit and cracked stone. Comparing the two still lifes shows what a repeated setup can reveal: when the surrounding format stays related, a changed contour becomes much more conspicuous.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 1615

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A Scholar in His Study

Justus Juncker

1754 · Städel Museum



Justus Juncker. A Scholar in his Study. Image credit: Justus Juncker; Source credit: https://rkd.nl/nl/explore/images/254454. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

Books and accumulated objects establish study as a material practice rather than an invisible mental condition. Light gathers near the table while the room's edges remain less legible. Juncker separates a working area from its crowded surroundings. The painting can show the conditions of concentrated attention without pretending to make the scholar's thoughts available.

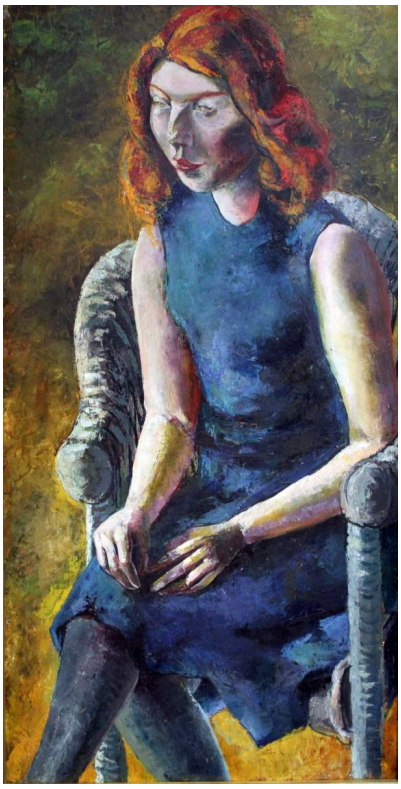
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 616

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Young Woman in a Wicker Chair

Hanns Katz

c. 1933–1934 · Städel Museum



Hanns Katz. Young Woman in a Wicker Chair. Image credit: Hanns Ludwig Katz (1892-1940). Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The chair curves around a narrow body whose hands remain close to the knees. Strong red hair and blue clothing keep the sitter distinct within the compressed arrangement. Katz makes support and ease different questions: a chair may physically contain a figure without making the pose look expansive. That observation need not become a diagnosis of her feelings.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 2254

10 / 20

The Courtyard of the Orphanage in Amsterdam

Max Liebermann

1881 – 1882 · Oil on canvas · Städel Museum



Städel Museum, Frankfurt am Main, Eigentum des Städelschen Museums-Vereins e.V.. Public Domain. Full source frame preserved; proportional resize and JPEG compression. · Public Domain

Repeated uniforms establish an institution, but the girls do not repeat one pose. Some stand, others sit, and their separate pauses remain visible along the shaded building. Liebermann sets that variation against sunlight broken by trees. The courtyard is shared space in which belonging to a group does not erase individual positions or activity.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 1351

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Carmencita

Lovis Corinth

1924 · Städel Museum



Lovis Corinth. Carmencita. Image credit: Lovis Corinth. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

Broad strokes let dress and setting partly merge, making the surface more restless than a smoothly enclosed portrait would be. Firm accents near the face keep the sitter from disappearing into that activity. Corinth distributes clarity selectively. Recognition is maintained at a few points while the surrounding paint retains the freedom to interrupt stable outlines.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 2064

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Conflagration at Night

Johann Georg Trautmann

1762–1769 · Städel Museum



Johann Georg Trautmann. Conflagration at Night. Image credit: Johann Georg Trautmann; Source credit: https://rkd.nl/nl/explore/images/275260. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The fire supplies the illumination that reveals its own damage. Buildings and small figures gather in the blaze's reach, while surrounding darkness limits what can be known. A tree interrupts the glow rather than allowing it to become one continuous bright area. Trautmann turns disaster into a scene whose visibility depends on the destructive event itself.

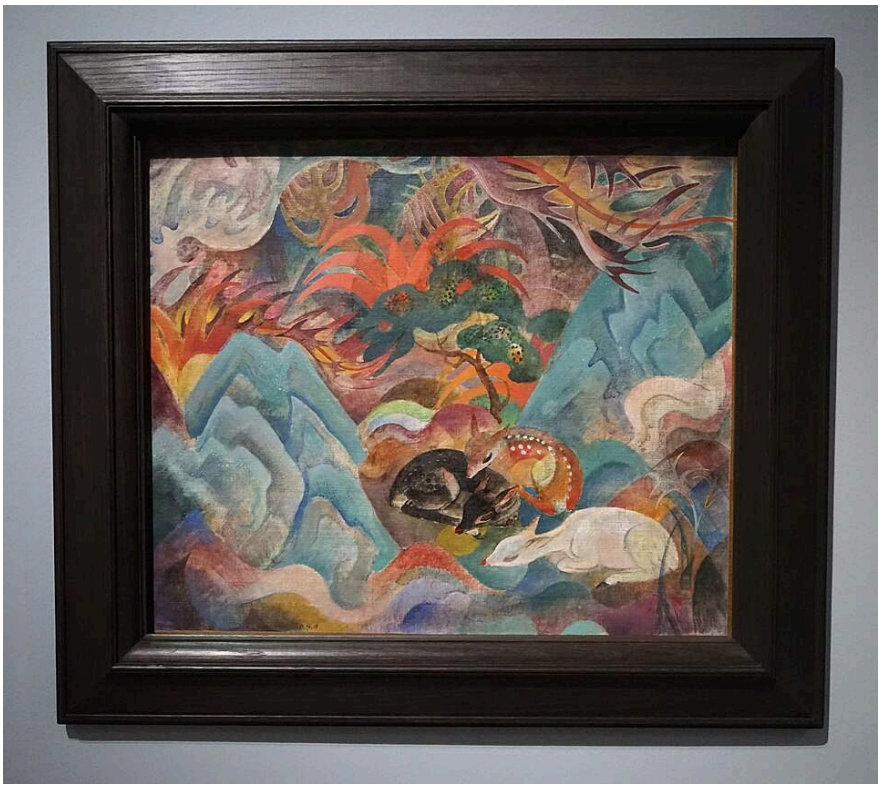
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 1339

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Deer in a Japanese Landscape

Jean-Bloé Niestlé

1918 · Städel Museum



Jean-Bloé Niestlé. Deer in Japanese Landscape. Image credit: Carl Ha; Own work. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Jean_Blo%C3%A9_Niestl%C3%A9,_Rehe_in_japanischer_Landschaft,_1918.jpg. CC BY-SA 4.0 (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/4.0/). Full-frame resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · CC BY-SA 4.0

Recognisable deer inhabit sharply coloured plants and terrain that resist a single stable perspective. Niestlé makes the animals share space with a conspicuous decorative arrangement. The title should not be treated as proof of a directly observed location. Following colour and curved forms reveals how the setting has been constructed around its living subjects.

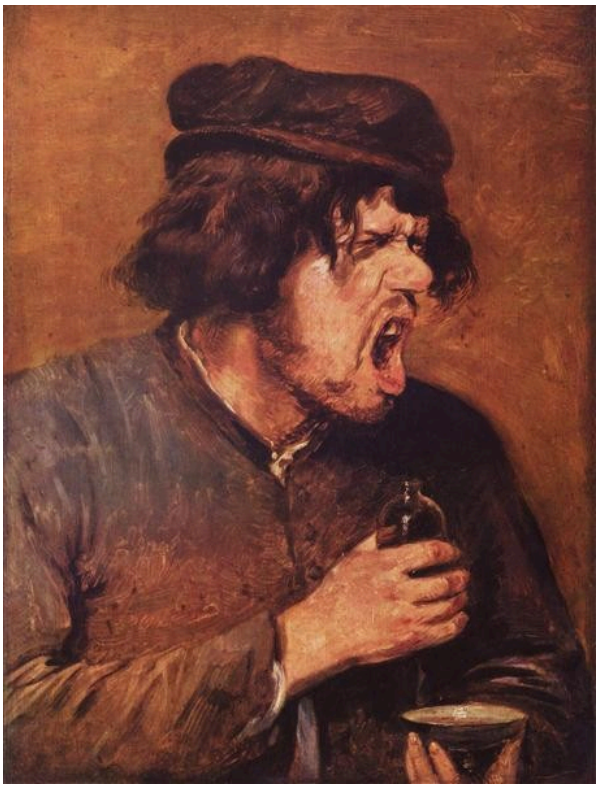
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: SG 408

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The Bitter Draught

Adriaen Brouwer

1630-1638 · Städel Museum



Adriaen Brouwer. The Bitter Drunk. Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

The drink has produced a reaction that interrupts any composed portrait pose. Narrowed eyes, open mouth and the grip on the vessel make an ordinary sensation the whole subject. Brouwer gives attention to a face in transition rather than a settled identity. The grimace is particular enough to carry the scene without a larger anecdote.

Object source · Open artwork

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Houses on the Zaan

Claude Monet

1871-1872 · Städel Museum



Claude Monet. Häuser am Ufer der Zaan. Städel Museum, Frankfurt am Main. Public Domain Mark (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame proportional resize and JPEG compression. · Public Domain Mark 1.0

Repeated green façades give the bank a clear rhythm. In the water, their counterparts break into smaller strokes and less stable boundaries. Monet establishes a comparison within one view: buildings retain enough firmness to measure what their reflections lose. The river is therefore an active second description of the shore, not merely a coloured strip beneath it.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 1385

16 / 20

In the Stock Exchange

Ferdinand Brütt

1891 · Städel Museum



In the Stock Exchange. Ferdinand Brütt; Städel Museum, Frankfurt am Main. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame resize and JPEG compression. · Public domain

Financial activity appears through proximity, turns of bodies and small groups in conversation. Brütt places these difficult-to-read exchanges within a high public interior, giving them a scale beyond the individuals involved. The room establishes an institution while the clustered figures show its operation. The painting cannot disclose each transaction, but it can describe the conditions of exchange.

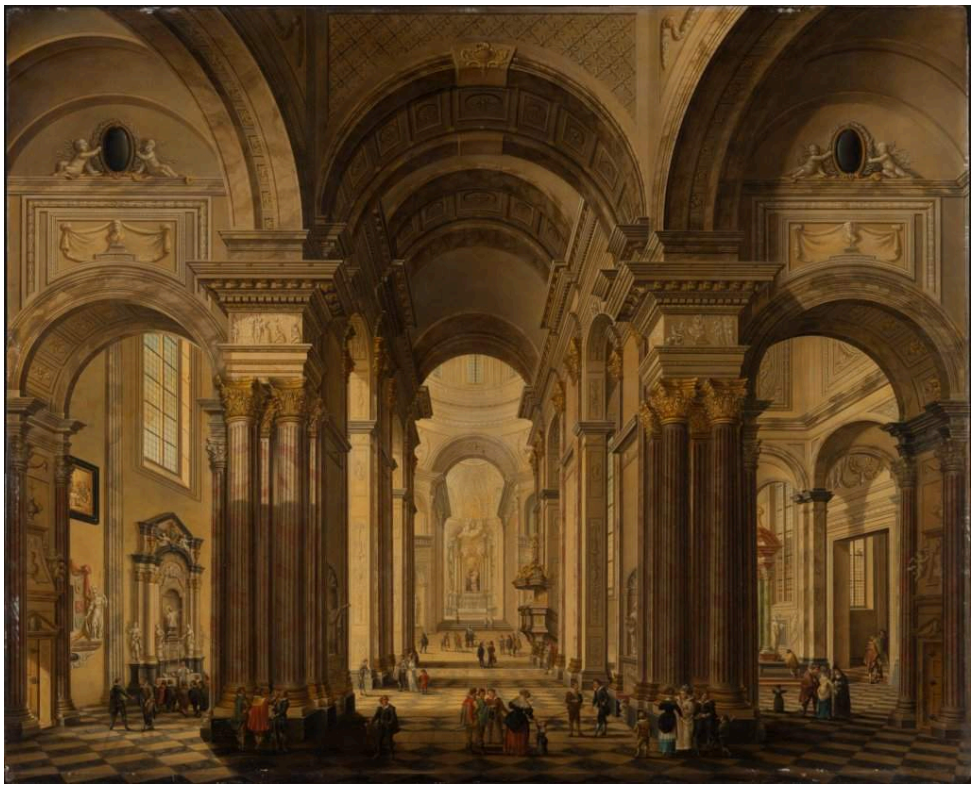
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: SG 326

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Interior of a Baroque Church

Johann Ludwig Ernst Morgenstern

1792 · Städel Museum



Interior of a Baroque Church. Johann Ludwig Ernst Morgenstern; Städel Museum, Frankfurt am Main. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame resize and JPEG compression. · Public domain

Arches, columns and the dome connect successive areas of the interior. Small people make the architecture's scale legible without supplying the main event. Morgenstern gives the building several ways of directing attention through rounded forms and layered openings. The space is organised for movement and looking, even when the figures themselves occupy only a small part of it.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 609

18 / 20

Interior of a Gothic Church

Johann Ludwig Ernst Morgenstern

1793 · Städel Museum



Interior of a Gothic Church. Johann Ludwig Ernst Morgenstern; Städel Museum, Frankfurt am Main. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame resize and JPEG compression. · Public domain

Pointed arches and slender supports repeat towards the distant altar. Their upward emphasis differs from the broader rounded forms in Morgenstern's Baroque interior. The pair offers a practical comparison of spatial organisation without requiring a complete account of either architectural style. Follow what repeats and where those repetitions lead the eye.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 574

19 / 20

Jewish Street in Amsterdam

Max Liebermann

1908 · Oil on wood · Städel Museum



Städel Museum, Frankfurt am Main. Public Domain. Full source frame preserved; proportional resize and JPEG compression. · Public Domain

Bright produce makes small transactions distinguishable within the darker crowd. Liebermann describes the neighbourhood through a gathering around a stall rather than a solitary architectural landmark. Brick façades provide continuity behind the changing activity. Public space becomes legible through what people do together, while their individual exchanges remain only partly accessible to a viewer.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: SG 172

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Kitchen Interior with Three Women

Justus Juncker

1750 · Städel Museum



Kitchen Interior with Three Women. Justus Juncker; Städel Museum, Frankfurt am Main. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame resize and JPEG compression. · Public domain

Sleeves, utensils and ingredients occupy the kitchen's lighter area, directing attention to work at the table. Juncker gives each woman a different gesture within the shared task. Their positions make sense through coordination rather than through a formal group pose. The room is described by its use, with food preparation organising the people and objects together.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 2006

Change scale deliberately

Move between the isolated fruit, Brouwer's face and the large interiors. Notice how surrounding space changes the apparent importance of each subject. Use the Städel's current collection records for display information; this selection is intended for comparison, not as a fixed itinerary.

Further reading

Impressionism: A Centenary Exhibition

Anne Dayez, Michel Hoog and Charles S. Moffett · Read online or download · English

This exhibition catalogue supplies context for Monet’s domestic scene and river view. Its essays and illustrations help place their handling of light beside the later city scenes in this selection.

Museum website · Official collection guide

Sources and visitor information checked: 2026-10-12